

Operating Systems [2026-2027]

Support doc – Using student2.dei.uc.pt

Introduction

In some cases, the use of the provided **virtual machine image** (preferred option for Operating System classes!) is not possible or it runs too slow. In this case, the use of the server ***student2.dei.uc.pt*** may be an option.

Do not use ***student.dei.uc.pt*** as your working machine! This server is used to support services to students, **not class works**! **Only *student2.dei.uc.pt*** should be used!

How to access?

Open a shell in your laptop:

- In Windows go to search and type `cmd`
- In MacOS go to search and type `terminal`

Type `ssh` in the command prompt to check if it is installed. If not, it must be installed before proceeding.

The server *student2.dei.uc.pt* (*student2*) cannot be accessed directly. To access it, you must first login into *student.dei.uc.pt* (*student*) using the same login as the one provided by the Department of Informatics Engineering of the University of Coimbra (DEI). Both machines share the same disk – when a file is saved to *student*, it is also in *student2*.

To access *student*, a **ssh (Secure Shell)** client should be used.

Example of a login from a user named “vasco”:

```
ssh vasco@student.dei.uc.pt
```

A password must be provided to confirm the login - it is the same as the one used by your mail at DEI (do not worry that what you type is not shown in the screen, just type the password and press RETURN in the end).

Once the login to *student* is successful, you can connect to *student2* using another ssh session.

From the *student* prompt write:

```
ssh student2.dei.uc.pt
```

(the user will be, by default, the same used to login to *student*)

How to transfer files to/from student2?

As the filesystem of *student* and *student2* are the same, and there is only external access to *student*, the transfer of files between your host and the server should be done directly to *student*. To accomplish it, any FTP client that supports **Secure File Transfer Protocol (SFTP)** can be used (e.g., FileZilla).